

Where the noise is off the rails

A search for the loudest screech on the MBTA

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

Everyone knows the MBTA can be loud. Ever wonder exactly *how* loud?

Try pin-your-ears-back rock concert loud. Or jackhammer, or chain saw loud.

That's what the Globe discovered at several of the T's most infamously noisy sections, with help from a sound level meter that measured the decibel output of all the rumbling and squealing train cars.

Veteran riders won't be surprised to learn that several stops with reputations for noisiness were, indeed, piercing. Inside the Government Center stop at peak screech, the sound level hit an average of 105 dBA. At Park Street Station, trains rounding a tight corner averaged 111 dBA.

And at Boylston Station, the screech of trains heading east hit an average of 104 dBA, with a peak reading of 115 dBA, on par with a rock concert or sand blaster.

That is way too loud, said Dr. Erica Walker, a sound researcher at Brown University who has

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Sound readings

averaged over multiple visits on separate days, in dBA

Inside Boylston Station, as trains headed west	85
On a Red Line train traveling from Harvard to Porter	90
On a Red Line train traveling from Porter to Harvard	92
Inside Boylston, as Green Line trains headed east	104
Inside Government Center, as trains entered the station	105
Inside Park Street, as Green Line trains entered the station	111

George Foreman, who shocked the boxing world by regaining his title at the age of 45, died at 76. His fame and amiable personality later led to a multimillion-dollar grill business. **C2.**



A sitting Cambridge city councilor and a local doctor were among those publicly identified in court as men who allegedly bought sex through a local brothel ring that operated out of luxury apartments. **B1.**

The FDA cleared Alnylam Pharmaceuticals' treatment for a progressive heart condition, setting it up to compete with therapies from BridgeBio and Pfizer. **D1.**

Spring teaser

Saturday: Sun then clouds. High: 58-63. Low: 26-31.

Sunday: Cooler, sunny. High: 41-46. Low: 30-35.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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The memorandum also laid out conditions for the university's 'continued financial relationship with the United States government.'

Columbia yields to Trump demands

Democratic governors finding a solution in laid-off federal workers

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

Over the last two months, federal agencies have been discarding employees across the country at an unprecedented rate as a part of Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency purge.

Several governors hope to make the federal government's loss their gain.

Multiple state governments — almost exclusively led by Democratic governors — have launched websites with resources for laid-off federal

workers, such as interview tips, resume reviews, and job openings. But some have taken their efforts a step further, actively recruiting laid-off federal workers from around the United States to fill vacancies in state government.

Pennsylvania and Hawaii have implemented an expedited hiring process for laid-off federal workers seeking employment in their states. While New York has launched a highly visible marketing campaign, advertising job openings in the

WORKERS, Page A7

Musk meeting

President Trump said his adviser didn't talk about China at the Pentagon. **A6.**

Judge's response

Judge vows to 'get to the bottom' of whether his order to stop certain deportations was defied. **A7.**

Will change protest rules, add oversight to certain departments

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

Columbia University on Friday granted President Trump nearly every demand his administration made in a letter last week that accused the school of mishandling campus protests and antisemitism, and laid out conditions for the school's "continued financial relationship with the United States government."

Columbia said in a memorandum that it would revamp rules governing campus protests and student discipline,

ban masks that conceal the identity of protesters, expand the "intellectual diversity" of its faculty, and appoint a new administrator who will oversee all departments studying the Middle East to ensure "the educational offerings are comprehensive and balanced." The school has also hired 36 "special officers" who will have the power to remove people from campus and make arrests.

The demands, and Columbia's capitulation, mark an extraordinary intervention by the

COLUMBIA, Page A7

The US Department of Agriculture cut more than **\$1 billion** in funding for two programs that provide money to food banks, child care centers, and schools to purchase locally grown food.



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

USDA CUTS UNNERVE SMALL FARMERS IN R.I.

Loss of funds to help nonprofits buy local will be felt on 2 fronts

By Amanda Milkovits
GLOBE STAFF

CRANSTON, R.I. — The farmers bent over trays of tender seedlings of Swiss chard, little habaneros, slips of kale, basil, and collard greens, gently shifting the tiny shoots into soil where they can thrive.

They don't know whether anyone will be able to buy the produce they're planting.

In the sunlit warmth of a greenhouse at Urban Edge Farm, Ben Torpey, the farm manager from Southside Community Land Trust, delivered the news last week to some of the small farmers who grow their crops there: More than 400 miles away in Washington, D.C.,

the US Department of Agriculture cut more than \$1 billion in funding for two programs that provide money to food banks, child care centers, and schools to purchase locally grown food.

That included nearly \$3 million to Rhode Island, funding that affects about 100 small businesses in the state that supply local produce, meat, and fish to Rhode Island schoolchildren, food banks, and communities in need.

The sudden cancellation jolted the farmers who are gearing up for the growing season.

"It's too much. We don't know what to do," said Gar-

USDA, Page A6

Odille Nyisaruhongore (left) and Charlotte Uwimpuhwe tended to seedlings at Urban Edge Farm in Cranston, R.I.

A pair of young brothers share a fish story

They're winning hearts and awards with their pastime

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — It's a cold afternoon along the banks of the Charles River, and the Leslie brothers are doing what they do nearly every day of the year, which is chasing big fish.

It's something they are exceptionally good at, which is why Kyler, 13, and Ryker, 10, have exploded onto the local fishing scene over the last several weeks, racking up big awards, state records, and one mega-viral video.

On March 15, MassWildlife named the brothers from Peter-sham as co-winners of their Youth Angler of the Year award, following a 2024 where they each

tied a state record by catching trophy-size fish for 23 of the 24 eligible freshwater species.

And it comes just weeks after Kyler Leslie became an Internet darling after video of him landing a 25-inch-long largemouth bass while ice fishing — which equaled the state catch-and-release record — was covered by Outdoor Life Magazine. An edited version of the video shared on the magazine's Instagram page has been seen more than 6 million times, and many commenters connected with his childlike joy and endless exclamations of "Oh my God, oh my God, oh my God" as he pulled the unexpected



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PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Kyler Leslie (above) and brother Ryker (right) fished more than 300 days in 2024, traveling all over on their way to becoming the state's Youth Anglers of the Year.